

ENERGY-EFFICIENT PRODUCTS WILL BE THE FUTURE TREND



Few would dispute that Microtek International is a leading peripherals manufacturer, claiming to be the 'most preferred brand.' Managing that commanding position falls largely on its seasoned chairman, N.K. Aggarwal. In his years at the company, Aggarwal has delivered steady growth while expanding Microtek's reach worldwide. Speaking to Srabani Sen, Aggarwal edifies on the present and future trends of the UPS and inverter segment, going by the needs of the enterprises.

■ N.K. AGGARWAL
CHAIRMAN, MICROTEK INTERNATIONAL

How do enterprises perceive power conditioning? How can your company help them in it?

Enterprises mainly look for UPS, inverters and online UPS for power conditioning. They are also looking for solar-based solutions for this sector. Our company's blueprint is to maintain our stronghold in the area. Our strategy is to make available products as per the requirements of customers. Our R&D division is working on solar-based solutions. It is a continuous effort to find customised solutions.

Do you see a shift in the market towards centralised UPS? What are its major benefits from the enterprise's perspective?

Both centralised as well as decentralised UPS concepts are prevailing in the market. Centralised UPS system is catered to by online UPS and the decentralised system is catered to by line-interactive UPS. Both segments are equally strong because there is a big market of single-PC users, who opt for decentralised systems. Centralised system is for the multi-PC users. Less space requirement and longer backups are the major benefits of these systems. It all depends on the application and needs of the customers.

What, according to you, are the features of ideal UPS and inverters to address this sector?

Enterprises don't want to compromise on the safety of their valuable data and appliances, which can be damaged by frequent or uneven power supply. Products must be user-friendly and supported by excellent service backup. Besides, these should fulfil the customers' requirements.

In this era of tough competition, service is the key to survival. What is your approach to this critical area of the industry. How do you achieve this?

After-sales service is the most important part for survival in this competitive environment. The approach to this critical area should be clear. We have been maintaining and expanding our service network continuously, which has now burgeoned to 28 service centres and 255 service points

across India. We have been upgrading and training our service engineers regularly.

What are the future trends visible in the UPS and inverter market?

Future trends are going to be energy-efficient series of products, as well as renewable energy-based applications like solar.

How good is the demand for home inverters with inbuilt UPS to run home computers during power-cuts? Do these run home appliances as well?

There is a growing demand for home inverters with inbuilt UPS for using computers during power cuts. These models are designed for both computers as well as other home appliances.

Do you think customised solutions to critical applications are increasingly becoming more relevant?

Yes, as technology is developing, so are the needs of critical applications. In some cases customised solutions become a must. Our company has an in-house R&D division run by a team of highly qualified professionals, which is always helpful for customised solutions.

How do you see the role of power electronics in electrical power conversion?

With the development of technologies over the next few years, the role of power electronics is going to increase. The new technologies will help power electronics to reduce energy losses and effectively use the available energy.

How do you envisage the possible competition from low-cost manufacturing countries (for your range of products), both in the Indian and global arena?

We are making our manufacturing setup competent enough without compromising on the quality front. We never face any problem from these low-cost manufacturing companies because the products produced by them are far inferior to the products manufactured by us.